



At least as many people as possible

ingot from the melt (If you're aware how the Czochralski process works). To do this, first map out all the characteristics you could obtain from your user research. Do this visually. Sticky notes are a great tool for this, as they also make the next step easier – grouping those characteristics into categories. Needless to say, these should be groups that pertain to your product. For example, if you were creating personas for a weight loss application, you might categorise groups based on “current weight” and “intended weight loss”.

An important tip. The next couple of steps should definitely involve the whole team because now you must decide the boundaries for the finalised critical characteristics. These boundaries are important to prevent you from going down the rabbit hole of trying to design for “everyone”. To continue with the example of the weight loss app, let's exaggerate it a bit to drive home our point. It would probably not be a good idea if you made a persona called ‘Jumbo’ and tried to design your application for elephants as well.

Now that we have that out of the way, let's focus on the next step – placing characteristics within your categories. This will be followed by developing a few key personas, who need to be very realistic. In our example, within the “current weight” group, you may categorise into “light” (40kg - 60kg), “middle” (60kg - 85kg) and “heavy” (85kg - 120kg). Further, you may create such groups within the “intended weight loss” group and start to create